

AI Product Feedback Report

As an experienced Product Manager, I've analyzed the provided customer reviews to understand the current sentiment, identify critical issues, and pinpoint areas for strategic improvement.

1. Executive Summary

The overwhelming sentiment from recent customer reviews for Any.do is highly negative, bordering on hostile. Users are experiencing critical issues that directly impact their ability to use the app, leading to widespread frustration, anger, and a mass exodus. The primary problems revolve around ****severe app instability (crashing, not opening, data loss after updates), an aggressive and confusing monetization strategy that locks essential features behind an expensive paywall, and a complete breakdown of customer support.****

Past users, who once valued the app for its organizational capabilities, feel betrayed by updates that have destroyed functionality and erased their data. Basic UX principles appear to be ignored, leading to a clunky, unreliable experience. Unless these fundamental issues are addressed immediately and transparently, the product's reputation and user base are at severe risk of irreversible damage.

2. Top 5 User Pain Points

1. ****App Instability & Data Loss (Post-Updates):**** Users report frequent crashes, the app failing to open, and crucial data (tasks, lists, appointments) being deleted or corrupted following updates. This is a critical trust and usability issue, making the app unreliable for its core purpose.

* **Examples:** "cannot open the app anymore," "Constant crashing," "new update deleted all of my tasks," "I lost ALL of my appointment dates."

2. ****Aggressive & Confusing Monetization / Paywall:**** The pricing model is perceived as predatory and non-transparent. Users complain about being forced into yearly subscriptions without clear consent, essential features (like recurring reminders) being locked behind a high paywall, and a lack of monthly subscription options. Many feel tricked into payment.

* **Examples:** "Very costly for the premium version," "forced me to pay for it without any awareness," "No monthly subscriptions? Why should I be forced to subscribe for a year?", "locking basic features behind a paywall is kinda weird," "moneygrabber."

3. ****Non-existent Customer Support & Refund Issues:**** There are numerous reports of users "begging for a refund" or seeking assistance for bugs and subscription issues, only to be met with no response or delayed, unhelpful, copy-pasted replies. This exacerbates frustration and trust issues, especially for paying customers.

* **Examples:** "nobody is replying me," "Absolutely no support!", "Hopeless customer service... not received a response," "emailed you 3 times with no response."

4. ****Poor User Experience & Lack of Basic Customization:**** The app's usability has deteriorated, with users finding lists "jumbled together," widgets being "useless" due to lack of filtering, no persistent "last viewed list" option, and a general lack of functional customization (e.g., sub-lists, color labels, sound choices).

* **Examples:** "all jumbled together and I can't find what I need," "Widgets are useless because they always show all tasks I have, regardless of category," "too complicated for some simple tasks," "It doesn't have sub lists."

5. ****Broken Integrations & Sync:**** Key integrations like Google Calendar, Google Home, Alexa, and multi-device sync are consistently reported as non-functional, unreliable, or difficult to set up. This undermines the app's utility as a central organizing tool.

* **Examples:** "No longer works with Alexa," "does not effectively sync tasks and events from the Google Calendar," "doesn't sync grocery lists with Google home," "can't connect with other people

since last update."

3. Top 5 Positive Highlights

It's challenging to extract current positive highlights, as most positive feedback is qualified by "used to be" or immediately followed by a problem. However, these indicate the original value proposition and what users *want* the app to be:

1. **Past Effectiveness for Organization:** Many users mention that the app "used to keep me organized" or "used to work so well earlier," indicating that the core functionality and design once resonated strongly with their needs.
2. **Valued Core Concept (Task & Reminder Management):** Despite current frustrations, users downloaded the app for its core purpose (to-do lists, reminders). This suggests a strong market need and a potential desire to return if issues are resolved.
3. **Potential for Multi-Device Sync:** While currently broken, the fact that users attempt to set it up on multiple devices (phone, tablet) highlights the high value placed on a seamless cross-device experience.
4. **"Good Job!" on a (Temporary) Bug Fix:** One review noted, "I complain about not crashes and it was immediately fixed! Good job!!" (though the crashes returned). This hints at moments where the development team demonstrated responsiveness, even if inconsistently.
5. **"Amazing" App (Conditional):** One user referred to the app as "amazing - but the vibrations!" This very specific, conditional praise suggests that *some* users still see underlying potential or enjoy aspects of the UI/UX, if not for critical flaws.

4. Feature Suggestions

These suggestions are derived from the pain points and imply what users are looking for:

1. **Enhanced & Customizable Widgets:**
 - * Allow users to select specific lists/categories to display.
 - * Provide options for different widget sizes and information density.
 - * Ensure widgets reliably auto-refresh and display accurate, up-to-date information.
2. **Advanced List & Task Management:**
 - * **Sub-lists / Nested Tasks:** Enable hierarchical organization for complex projects or detailed grocery lists.
 - * **Persistent List View:** Option to default to the last-viewed list or a specific "priority" list upon app opening/reopening.
 - * **Improved Visual Cues:** More choices for color-coding, labels, and customizable sorting within lists.
3. **Smart Task Creation & Search:**
 - * **In-line Duplicate Detection:** As a user types a new task, automatically search existing tasks (at least within the current list) and suggest merging or indicate if it already exists.
 - * **Robust Global Search:** An intuitive and quick search function available across all platforms (mobile, web) to easily find any task or list.
4. **Reliable & Flexible Reminders:**
 - * **Granular Recurring Reminders:** Offer diverse, user-friendly options for recurring tasks (e.g., every 3rd Tuesday, specific days of the month, custom intervals) *without* locking basic functionality behind a paywall.
 - * **Location-Based Reminders Reliability:** Ensure these work consistently across different power-saving modes and devices.
 - * **Customizable Reminder Sounds/Vibrations:** Allow users to turn off vibrations independently and choose from a wider range of notification sounds.
5. **Seamless & Stable Integrations:**

- * **Robust Google Calendar Sync:** Ensure two-way sync, allow marking synced events as complete, and provide clear conflict resolution.
- * **Functional Smart Assistant Integration:** Clear, step-by-step instructions and reliable connectivity with Google Home and Alexa for adding and checking tasks.
- * **Improved Collaboration Features:** Ensure invitations link correctly and shared lists sync reliably across all participants' devices.

5. Product Improvement Recommendations

These are strategic, higher-level recommendations to address the systemic issues revealed by the reviews.

1. **Prioritize Core Stability & Reliability (QA First Initiative):**
 - * **Halt New Feature Development:** Redirect all development resources to fixing existing bugs, crashes, data loss issues, and ensuring app stability across all platforms and Android versions.
 - * **Implement Rigorous QA:** Establish a comprehensive testing protocol (unit, integration, regression, user acceptance testing) for *every* update, focusing heavily on preventing data loss and functional regressions.
 - * **"No Bug Left Behind" Policy:** Create a dedicated task force to systematically address the backlog of critical bugs and crashes.
2. **Overhaul Monetization Strategy & Transparency:**
 - * **Re-evaluate Paywall for Basic Features:** Unlock frequently requested basic functionalities (e.g., robust recurring reminders, basic list customization) from behind the paywall to improve free-tier value and reduce user friction.
 - * **Transparent Pricing & Trial:** Clearly communicate pricing, subscription terms, and trial auto-renewal *before* signup or trial initiation. Make it impossible for users to be charged without explicit, multi-step confirmation.
 - * **Offer Monthly Subscriptions:** Provide a monthly subscription option to reduce the barrier to entry and commitment for new users.
 - * **Easy Unsubscribe & Refund Process:** Implement a clear, user-friendly in-app mechanism for subscription cancellation and a transparent, easily accessible refund policy with prompt processing.
3. **Revitalize Customer Support & Communication:**
 - * **Increase Support Staff & Training:** Invest in significantly expanding and training the customer support team to handle the current volume of inquiries, especially refund requests and technical issues.
 - * **Guaranteed Response Times:** Establish and adhere to clear service level agreements (SLAs) for response times, particularly for premium users and critical issues.
 - * **Proactive Communication:** Implement a system for communicating known bugs, upcoming fixes, and changes to the app *before* they roll out. Engage constructively with negative reviews rather than using generic responses.
4. **Restore User Trust & Data Integrity:**
 - * **Data Migration & Backup Strategy:** For future updates, implement robust data migration tools and communicate clearly about backup/restore options. Consider a "cloud backup" feature for users.
 - * **"Guest" Mode / Optional Sign-in:** Allow users to explore basic app functionality for a period without forcing account creation or sharing personal data, reducing initial friction and perceived privacy invasion.
 - * **Post-Mortem & Apology:** For past major data loss events, consider a public acknowledgment, apology, and clear communication about steps being taken to prevent recurrence.
5. **Comprehensive User Experience (UX) Audit:**
 - * **Usability Testing:** Conduct extensive qualitative usability testing with both new and long-term users to identify current pain points related to navigation, task management, list organization, and integrations.
 - * **Simplify Complex Flows:** Streamline onboarding, task creation, and list management

processes to make the app more intuitive for users with varying levels of tech savviness.

* **Consistent Multi-Platform Experience:** Ensure a consistent and high-quality user experience across mobile, tablet, and web applications, with reliable sync between them.